US Lean Hog Market Report

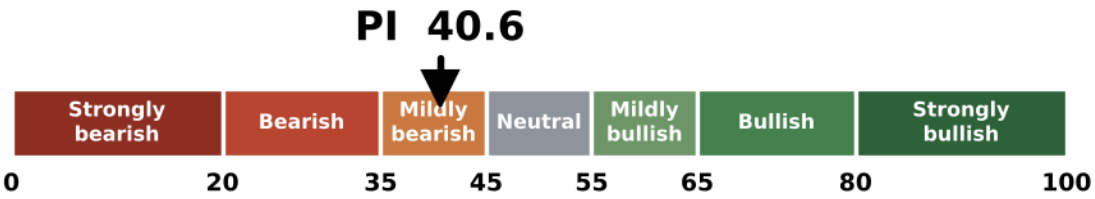
Daily price, supply, demand and positioning briefing | Compiled 2026-11-09 | USD with CAD at 1.3850

Data freshness — Core data not verified for this session
6 of 15 series were confirmed for 2026-11-09. Carried forward: Producer base, all types (2026-11-06), Pork carcass cutout (2026-11-06). Every figure in this report is stamped with its own as-of date, and PI reports reduced data completeness rather than filling gaps. Treat anything dated before 2026-11-09 as the last published value, not today's.

NEGOTIATED BASE PRICE	PRODUCER BASE, ALL TYPES	PORK CARCASS CUTOUT	PACKER MARGIN PROXY
$46.21	**$64.54**	**$70.65**	**$6.11**
+4.42 C$64.00 /cwt · Nov 6	-0.41 C$89.39 /cwt · Nov 6	+1.66 C$97.85 /cwt · Nov 6	+2.07 C$8.46 /cwt · Nov 6
SEW 10-12 LB, CASH	**SOW PRICE, WTD AVG**	**EST. FEED COST**	**FUND NET SHORT**
$22.35	**$67.82**	**$26.12**	**59,072**
C$30.95 per head · weekly	C$93.93 /cwt live · Oct 19	C$36.18 /cwt carcass	near record contracts · Oct 27
DEC CORN	**DEC SOYBEAN MEAL**	**FROZEN PORK STOCKS**	**BREEDING HERD**
$4.39	**$320.70**	**427.8M**	**5.875M**
+0.02 C$6.08 /bu	+0.60 C$444.17 /ton	+9.0% YoY lb · Sep 30	-1.0% YoY head · Sep 1

Projection Indicator (PI)

The whole report plus the three nearest futures contracts, resolved into one score. Horizon 4-6 weeks.



PI 40.6 — Mildly bearish. Fundamentals sit marginally below what the futures curve already prices. Market-implied base $57.56/cwt; PI tilts it to **$56.69**, 60% band $51.87–$61.51. Data completeness 79%. Full breakdown overleaf.

Where the market stands

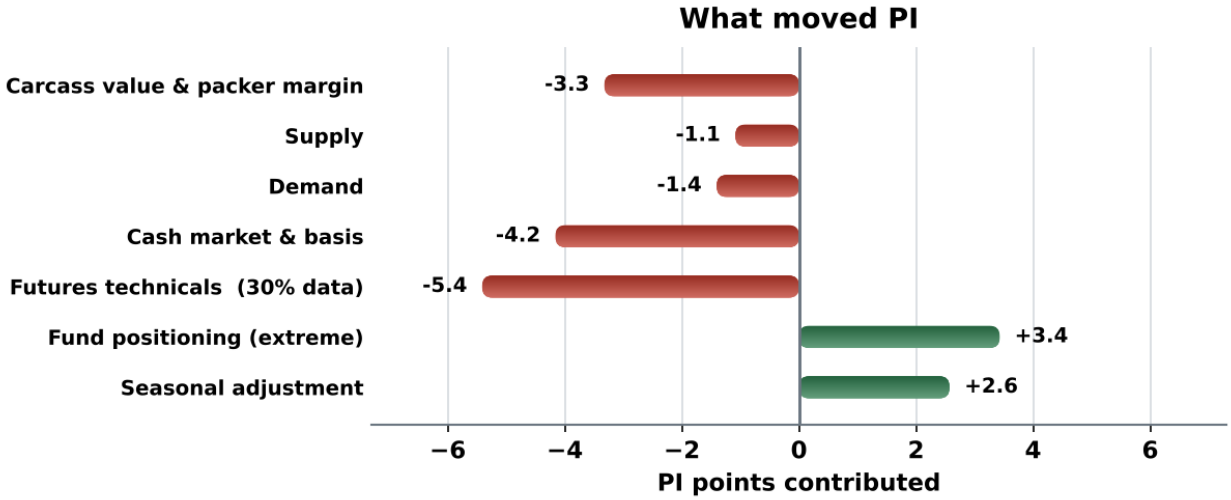
The negotiated cash market has fallen apart over the past two weeks. The national negotiated base price printed **$46.21/cwt** on Nov 6, up **$4.42** on the day and roughly **$25/cwt** below where the same series traded in mid-October. The five-day rolling average sits at $45.31. Critically, the break is **not** matched by the wider market: producer-sold hogs across all purchase types still based at **$64.54/cwt** on Nov 6, and formula hogs on Nov 6 based at $59.42. The negotiated print covers roughly **0.2%** of plant-delivered volume on that day.

Meanwhile the pork cutout printed **$70.65/cwt** on Nov 6, up $1.66 on the day. The result is a cutout-to-base spread of **$6.11/cwt**, up from $4.04 the session before — packer gross margin on the producer-sold base. On the supply side, every market hog weight class ran 1.5-1.6% below a year ago on September 1 and the breeding herd is the smallest for that date since 2013, which does not support a cash break of this size. Frozen stocks at 9% above year-ago and a near-record fund short are the genuinely bearish points.

Read this before acting on the headline number
A $46.21 negotiated base price does not mean hogs are worth $46.21. That print came off 858 head — a sliver of one plant-day of spot trade — while 427,218 head moved the same day on formula and contract terms, tens of dollars higher. Thin negotiated volume plus USDA confidentiality suppression makes this series extremely jumpy. Use the all-purchase-type base price for valuation and the negotiated series only as a directional signal.

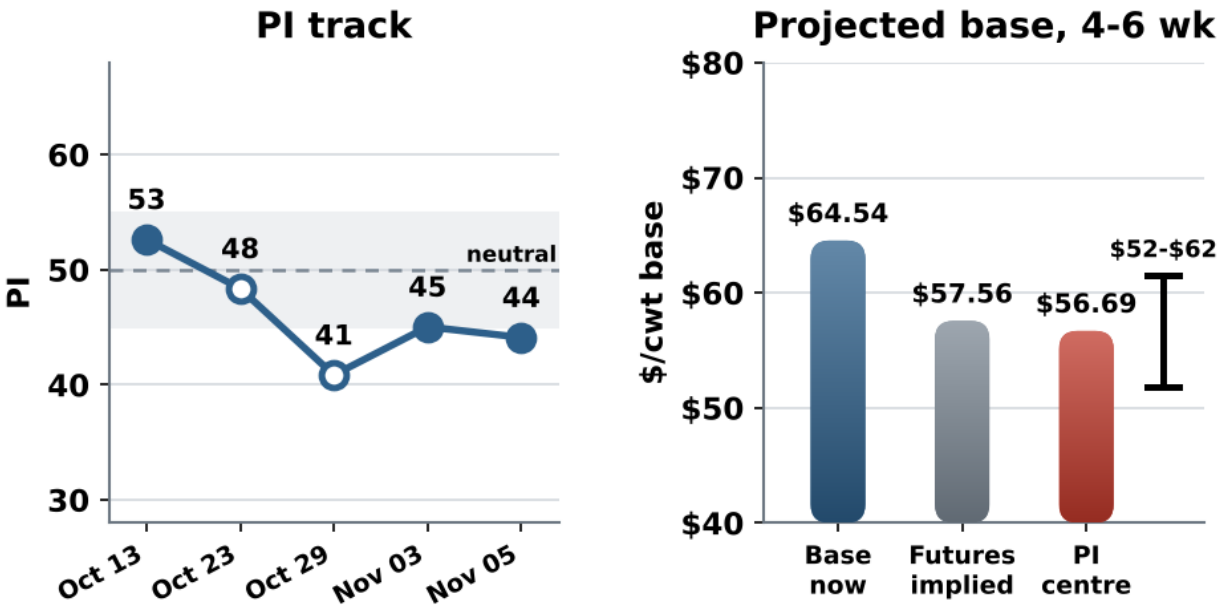
Projection Indicator — how the number is built

PI resolves the whole report into one 0-100 score. 50 is neutral. Blocks are weighted 70% fundamentals, 30% futures technicals.



Each bar is that block's contribution in PI points. Hollow markers on the track overleaf mark dates where one or more inputs were carried forward rather than separately verified.

Track and projection



PI is read **against the market's own forecast**, not in a vacuum. The December contract is itself a forecast of the cash index at expiry; the producer base runs about $1.68/cwt under that index, which gives a market-implied base of $57.56. PI then

says whether the fundamentals agree. At 40.6 it leans 1.5% below that pricing — broad agreement with the curve, with a mild bearish lean.

Component audit

Every input, its weight, its normalised score and the PI points it contributed. Nothing is hidden inside the formula.

Block / component	Weight	Score	PI points
Carcass value & packer margin	**0.22**	**-0.30**	**-3.3 pts**
Cutout level in range $70.65 within $68.99-$80.68 window	0.40	-0.72	
Cutout momentum -0.06% vs prior reading $70.69	0.35	-0.02	
Packer margin (level) cutout less all-types base = $6.11 vs $6.00 normal	0.25	-0.04	
Supply	**0.20**	**-0.11**	**-1.1 pts**
Slaughter vs year ago daily +3.01%, week-to-date +1.71%	0.30	-0.83	
180 lb+ forward supply -1.6% YoY - the next 4-6 weeks of kill	0.30	+0.66	
Carcass weight trend negotiated 224.09 lb vs packer-owned 217.20 lb	0.20	-0.88	
Breeding herd -1.0% YoY, smallest Sept herd since 2013	0.20	+0.58	
Demand	**0.18**	**-0.16**	**-1.4 pts**
Export net sales vs 4-wk avg 22,000 MT, -14% vs 4-wk	0.35	-0.65	
Export shipments vs 4-wk avg 29,400 MT, +13% vs 4-wk	0.30	+0.62	
Frozen pork stocks YoY 427.8M lb, +9.0% YoY	0.20	-0.81	
Frozen pork stocks MoM -1.0% on the month - drawing down	0.15	+0.32	
Cash market & basis	**0.10**	**-0.83**	**-4.2 pts**
Producer base trend $71.54 -> $64.54 (-9.78%)	0.50	-0.96	
Futures basis to cash index Dec $55.88 vs index $62.86 = $-6.98; futures are pricing the index lower into expiry	0.50	-0.70	
Futures technicals	**0.30**	**-0.36**	**-5.4 pts**
RSI(14), 3 contracts [no data] insufficient history - 12 Dec sessions available, 30 required	0.35	—	
MACD(12,26,9), 3 contracts [no data] insufficient history - 12 Dec sessions available, 60 required	0.35	—	
Term structure Dec->Apr +21.8% contango (was +10.8% Oct 23); dislocation priced as temporary, but outside this horizon	0.10	+0.65	
Front-contract momentum Dec -19.5% since Sep 30, -9.1% on the week	0.20	-0.87	
Overlay: fund positioning at extreme	capped	+0.069	**+3.4 pts**
Overlay: seasonal adjustment	capped	+0.051	**+2.6 pts**
PROJECTION INDICATOR			**40.6**

PI method and limits

Scale. 0-100, 50 neutral. Each component is normalised to [-1, +1], weighted inside its block, and the blocks combined 70% fundamentals / 30% futures technicals. PI = 50 + 50 x the weighted sum.

The negotiated price is excluded by design. It is 2.5% of volume and moves $7/cwt on a few thousand head. Including it would inject the exact noise this report warns against. Packer margin is therefore measured as cutout less the all-purchase-type base, not less the negotiated print.

Fund positioning is non-linear. Below the 90th percentile it confirms trend. Above it, it inverts and becomes contrarian, because the marginal seller is exhausted. A linear term would read maximally bearish at precisely the point squeeze risk is highest.

Horizon governs the futures weighting. Over 4-6 weeks the front contract dominates (60/25/15 across Dec, Feb, Apr). The steep contango out to spring says the dislocation is seen as temporary, but that is context for a later horizon, not a forecast for this one, so it carries only 10% of the technical block.

Missing inputs are not substituted. When a component has no data its weight is redistributed inside its own block and the loss of confidence is reported. RSI and MACD are fully implemented and validated against reference series, but need 30 and 60 sessions respectively; only 10 dated December sessions could be verified, so both are currently inactive and the technical block runs at 30% data.

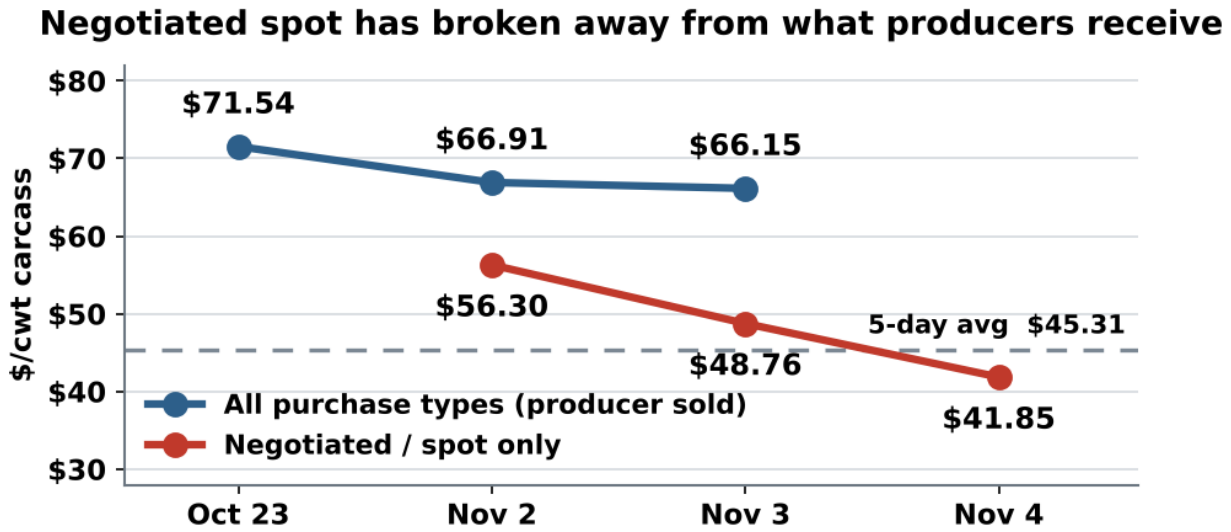
What PI is not. Until there is enough history to backtest against, PI is a structured opinion rather than a validated model. Its value is that it is explicit, consistent and auditable - the table above shows exactly what moved it. It does not carry a measured hit rate, and the 60% band is a judgement, not a measured confidence interval.

What to watch next

When	Release	Frequency	Why it matters right now
Nov 6	CFTC Commitments of Traders	Weekly	Did funds add to a near-record short, or start covering?
Thursdays	FAS weekly export sales	Weekly	Mexican ham demand is the cutout's main support.
~Nov 24	NASS Cold Storage, Oct 31 stocks	Monthly	Stocks already +9% YoY; another build confirms demand weakness.
Late Dec	NASS Quarterly Hogs and Pigs	Quarterly	Sets the forward supply map through mid-2027.
Daily	Negotiated head count	Daily	Under ~6,000 head, treat the print as noise.

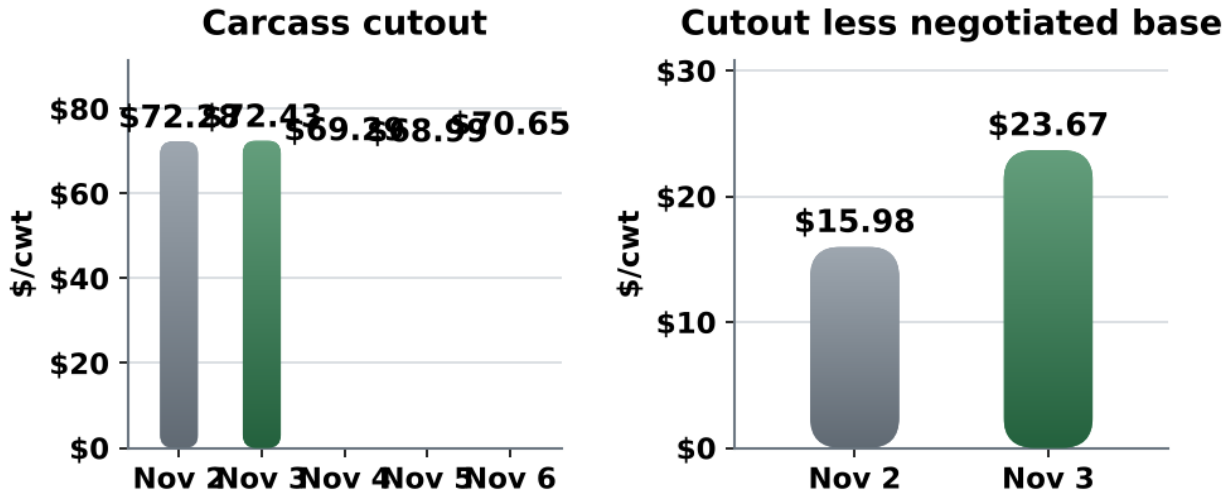
Lean hog price complex

National negotiated base price vs producer-sold base across all purchase types, carcass basis.



The blue line is what producers were paid across every purchase arrangement; the red line is the thin spot market that sets the headline. They moved together until the final week of October, then separated sharply; the gap stands at **$18.33/cwt**. A divergence of that size is a market-structure event, not a demand event.

Cutout and packer margin

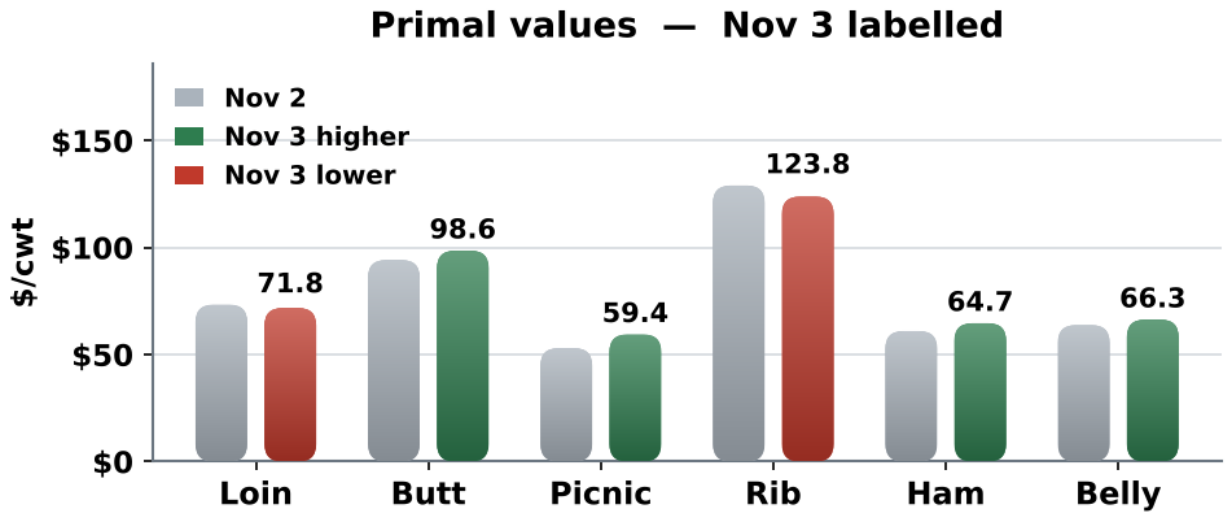


Carcass value and the hog bid have pulled apart, so the swing lands in packer margin. The cutout-to-base spread moved from $4.04 to **$6.11/cwt** on the latest session. On a 215 lb carcass that is **$13.14 per head** of gross margin between the hog and the box.

Price reference table

Measure ($/cwt carcass)	USD	CAD	Change	Day's range	As of
Negotiated base price	**$46.21**	$64.00	+4.42	$39.00 – $57.00	2026-11-06
Negotiated, 5-day rolling	**$45.31**	$62.75	—	—	2026-11-06
Producer base, all types	**$64.54**	$89.39	-0.76	—	2026-11-06
Pork carcass cutout	**$70.65**	$97.85	+1.66	—	2026-11-06
Cutout less negotiated base	**$21.89**	$30.32	+7.69	—	2026-11-06
By-product drop value	**$5.01**	$6.94	-0.09	—	2026-10-23
CME Lean Hog Index	**$63.93**	$88.54	—	—	2026-11-03

Primal values

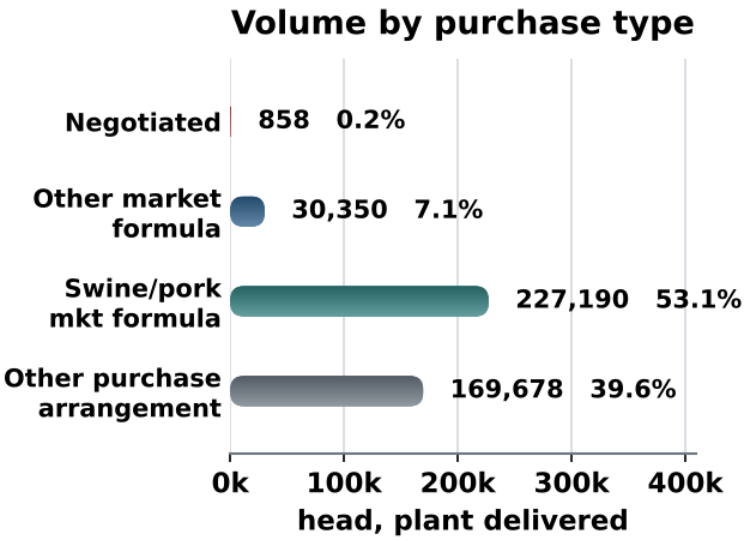


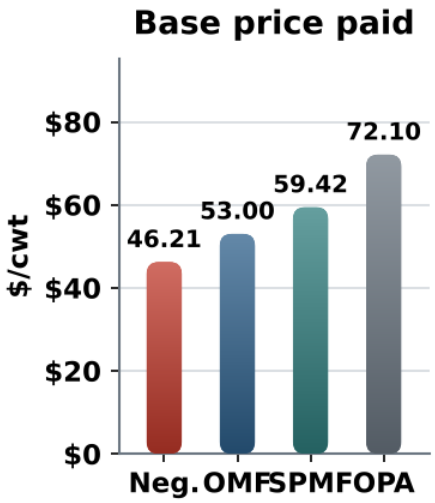
Picnic led higher (+$6.16) while rib gave back $9.35. Ham — the primal that matters most into the December holiday window — was essentially unchanged at $64.30. With the cutout flat and hams steady, there is no carcass-value justification for the cash break.

Primal ($/cwt)	Nov 2	Nov 3	Change	%	CAD Nov 3
Loin	$73.31	**$71.77**	-1.54	-2.1%	$99.40
Butt	$94.18	**$98.57**	+4.39	+4.7%	$136.52
Picnic	$52.99	**$59.41**	+6.42	+12.1%	$82.28
Rib	$129.02	**$123.84**	-5.18	-4.0%	$171.52
Ham	$60.98	**$64.65**	+3.67	+6.0%	$89.54
Belly	$63.76	**$66.34**	+2.58	+4.0%	$91.88

How thin the negotiated market really is

Plant-delivered purchases, barrows and gilts, carcass basis, November 6 2026.





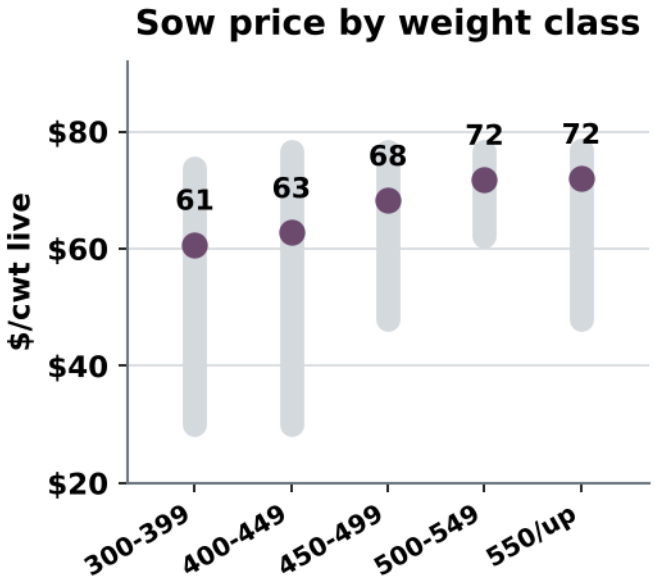
Purchase type	Basis	Head	Share	Base $/cwt	CAD $/cwt	$/head*
Negotiated	spot / cash	858	0.2%	**$46.21**	$64.00	$99.35
Other market formula	futures / options	30,350	7.1%	**$53.00**	$73.41	$113.95
Swine or pork mkt formula	cutout-linked	227,190	53.1%	**$59.42**	$82.30	$127.75
Other purchase arrangement	fixed / window	169,678	39.6%	**$72.10**	$99.86	$155.01

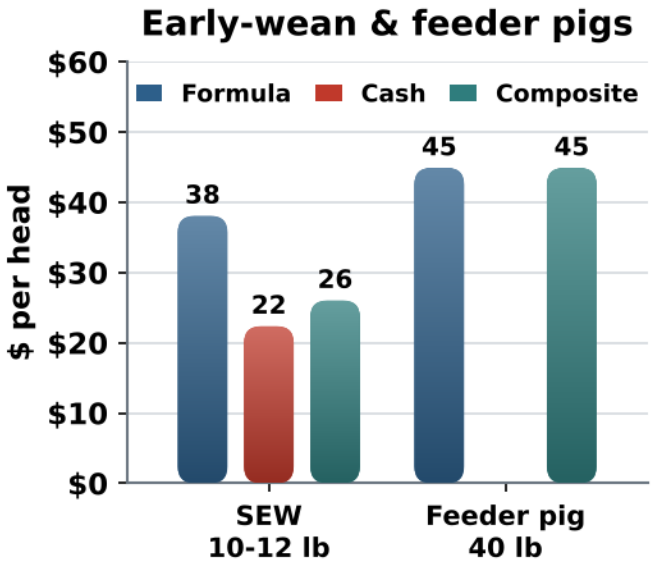
* Gross carcass revenue per head at a 215 lb carcass, before premiums, sort loss and deductions.

What the $18.33/cwt gap is worth per head

At a 215 lb carcass, the difference between the negotiated print ($46.21) and the all-purchase-type base ($64.54) is **$39.41 per head** — roughly C$54.58. That gap is the single most important number on this page, and it is the reason the headline price should never be used on its own to value a load.

Breeding stock and replacement pigs

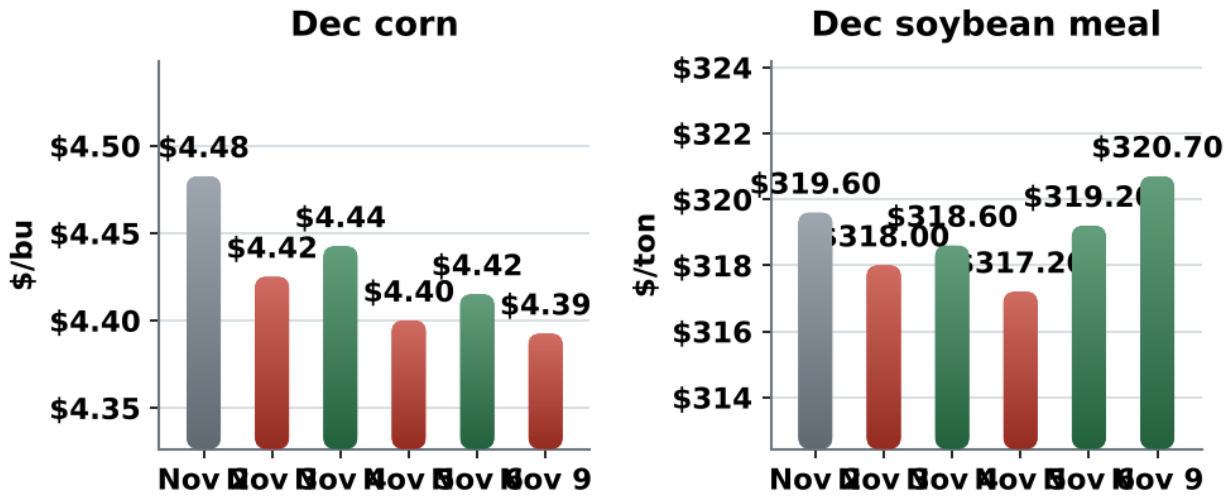




Sow weight class	Head	Avg wt	Wtd avg $/cwt	Range $/cwt	Est. $/head
300-399 lb	1,067	365	**$60.73**	$30.00 – $73.75	$221.66
400-449 lb	580	421	**$62.78**	$30.00 – $76.69	$264.30
450-499 lb	308	475	**$68.27**	$48.00 – $76.69	$324.28
500-549 lb	1,886	526	**$71.82**	$62.12 – $76.69	$377.77
550/up lb	667	588	**$72.00**	$48.00 – $76.75	$423.36
Weighted average	**4,508**		**$67.82**		

National negotiated sows, live basis, 2026-10-19. 865 head of the day's sow and boar volume originated in Canada. Cash SEW pigs at $22.35/head sit $15.71 below the formula price of $38.06 — the spot replacement-pig market is as weak as the spot hog market.

Feed costs



Note: value axes are truncated to show day-to-day movement; both series moved less than 1.5% across the three sessions.

Input	Rate	Price	USD	CAD
Corn	9.5 bu/head	$4.39/bu	**$41.73**	$57.79
Soybean meal	0.045 ton/head	$320.70/ton	**$14.43**	$19.99
Feed cost per head			**$56.16**	**$77.78**
Feed cost per cwt carcass	215 lb carcass		**$26.12**	**$36.18**

Feed model assumes 9.5 bu corn and 90 lb soybean meal per market hog to a 215 lb carcass, priced off December futures. Substitute your own rates and basis for a site-specific number; this is a market benchmark, not a ration cost.

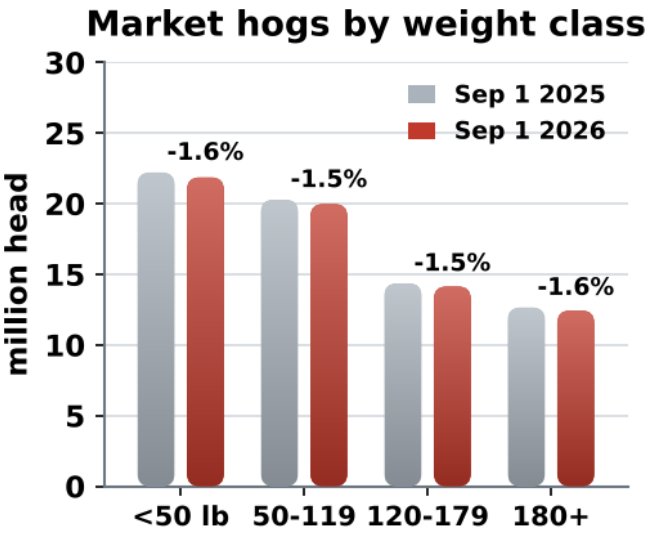
Slaughter and carcass weights

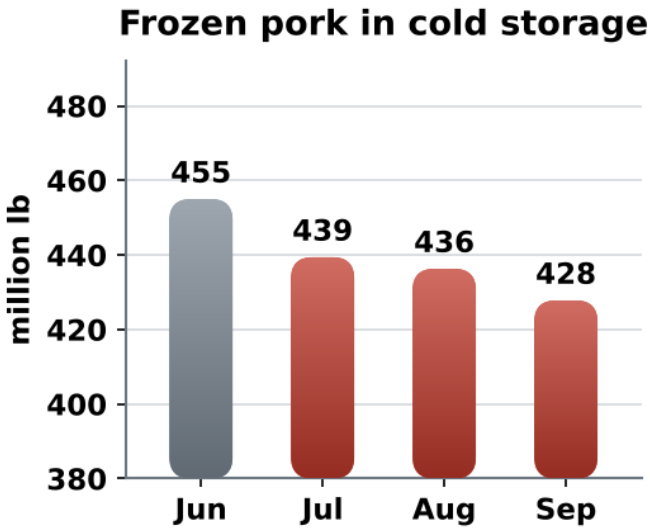
Slaughter (head)	Current	Week ago	Year ago	vs year ago
Daily slaughter under FIS (est.)	**485,000**	486,000	470,840	**+3.0%**
Week to date	**2,452,000**	2,418,000	2,410,676	**+1.7%**
Saturday kill (est.)	**202,000**	110,000	183,456	**+10.1%**

Average carcass weight	lb	Average carcass weight	lb
Negotiated	**224.09**	Swine/pork formula	**218.53**
Other market formula	**220.51**	Other arrangement	**219.70**
Combined	**220.06**	Packer owned	**217.20**

Carcass weight is the quiet supply variable: across a 2.4 million head week, a two-pound rise adds roughly 4.8 million lb of pork with no extra hogs. Negotiated hogs are running 6 lb heavier than packer-owned.

Herd inventory and cold storage



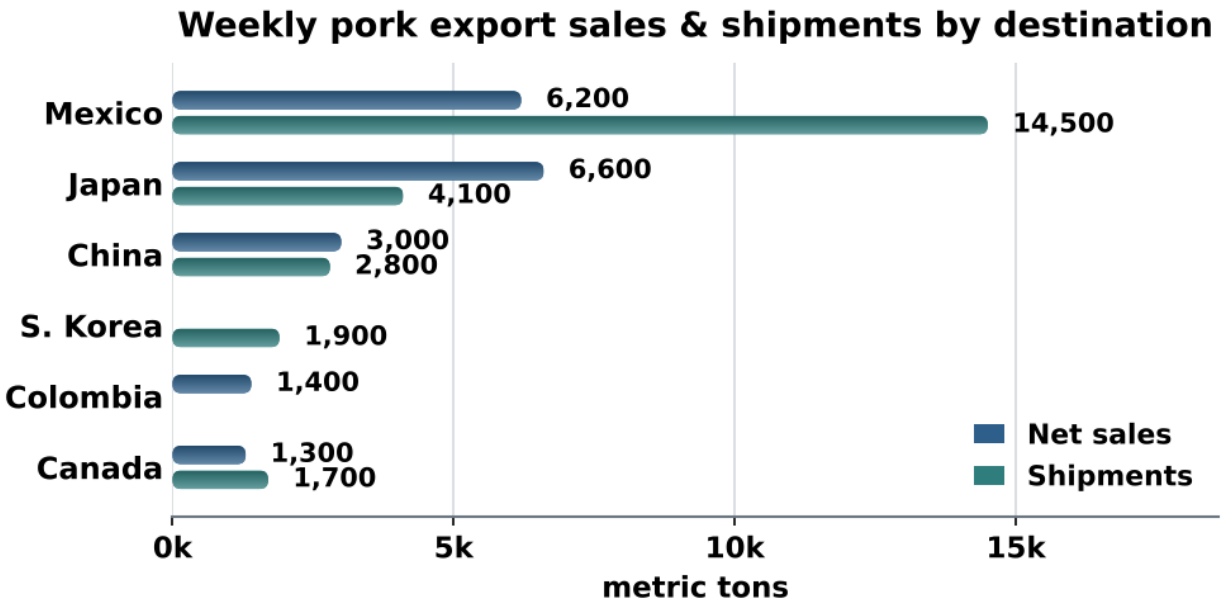


Inventory class (1,000 head)	Sep 1 2025	Sep 1 2026	YoY	Reaches market
All hogs & pigs	75,438	**74,302**	**-1.5%**	
Kept for breeding	5,936	**5,875**	**-1.0%**	
Market hogs	69,502	**68,427**	**-1.5%**	
Under 50 lb	22,211	**21,866**	**-1.6%**	Jan-Feb 2027
50-119 lb	20,283	**19,976**	**-1.5%**	Dec 26-Jan 27
120-179 lb	14,358	**14,142**	**-1.5%**	Nov-Dec 2026
180 lb +	12,650	**12,443**	**-1.6%**	Sep-mid Oct 2026

Smallest September breeding herd since 2013; fewest sows farrowing since 2002. Next Quarterly Hogs and Pigs: late December 2026.

Export demand

USDA FAS weekly export sales, pork muscle cuts. As of mid-October 2026.



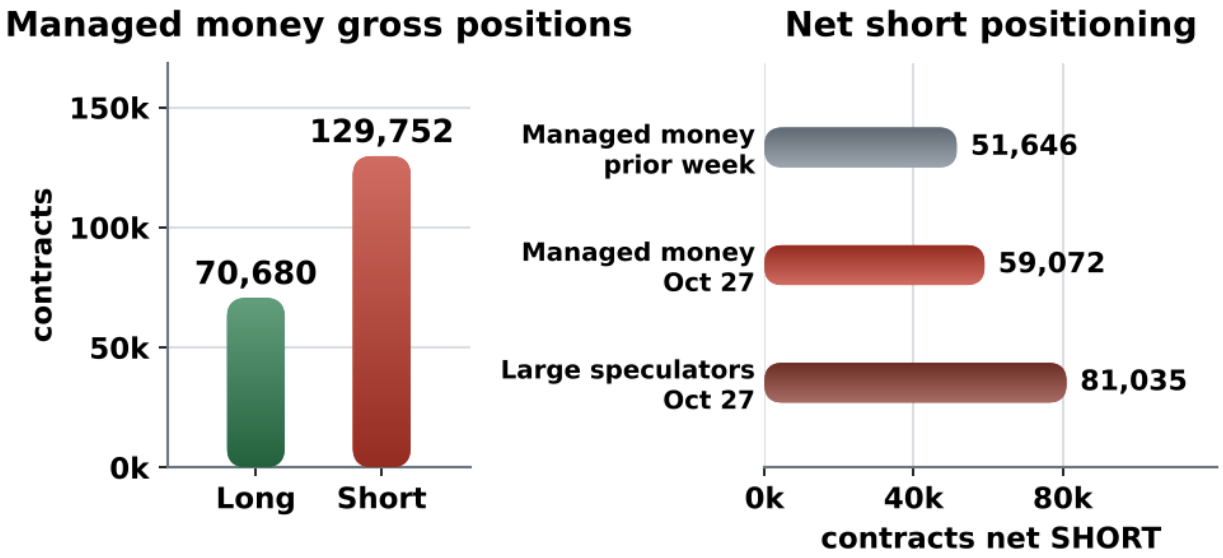
Net sales of **22,000 MT** ran 27% above the prior week but 14% below the four-week average. Shipments of **29,400 MT** were 26% higher on the week. Mexico remains the volume anchor, taking nearly half of all physical shipments; China bought in two consecutive weeks, which matters because Chinese participation has been intermittent under current tariff conditions. Roughly 25-30% of US pork production moves to export, so a sustained shift in Mexican or Chinese buying feeds directly into the cutout within two to three weeks.

Why exports belong on the first page of any hog report

Export demand is the largest single swing factor in US pork disappearance and the one least visible in daily cash prices. A quarter to a third of production leaves the country, and it leaves as specific cuts — hams and picnics to Mexico, variety meats to Asia. When Mexico steps back, the ham primal has nowhere domestic to go at the same value, and the cutout follows it down within two to three weeks. Watch the Thursday FAS release as a leading indicator of the following fortnight's cutout, not as a same-week price driver.

Speculative positioning

CFTC Commitments of Traders, Lean Hogs. Positions as of 2026-11-03, released 2026-11-06. Next release 2026-11-13.



Position	Contracts	Est. notional	Direction
Managed money long	**70,680**	$1.81B	long exposure
Managed money short	**129,752**	$3.32B	short exposure
Managed money net	**-59,072**	**$1.51B**	**net SHORT**
Large speculators net (legacy)	**-81,035**	$2.07B	net SHORT
Futures + options net (reported)	**-50,500**	—	separate series

Notional estimated at the CME Lean Hog Index of $63.93/cwt (2026-11-03) against a 40,000 lb contract. The futures-only disaggregated series and the futures-plus-options series are reported separately and do not reconcile to each other — both are shown rather than blended.

Positioning risk cuts both ways

Managed money net short widened to 59,072 contracts, the largest in at least five years; futures open interest rose 17,159 on the week to 324,455. A short base of 129,752 contracts against a contracting herd is the classic setup for a short-covering rally on any bullish surprise — a strong Hogs and Pigs number, a Chinese buying run, or a disease headline. Funds do not set the cash price, but they drive futures, and futures set the formula contracts that price two thirds of all hogs.

What actually moves the lean hog base price

Ranked by influence on the daily print, with the series to watch for each.

1	**Pork carcass cutout value** The strongest daily driver. Packers bid for hogs against the carcass value they expect to realise, so the base price tracks the cutout with a one-to-three day lag. The gap between them is packer gross margin, and it widens whenever hogs are plentiful relative to kill capacity. Ham and belly carry outsized weight seasonally — ham into the Q4 holiday window, belly through the summer BLT run.	*LM_PK602 daily, LM_PK600/601 morning*
2	**Slaughter capacity utilisation** When the weekly kill runs at or near industry capacity, packers have no need to bid up for the marginal hog and the negotiated price sags. When supply falls below capacity, plants compete and cash firms. Saturday kill volume is the cleanest marginal signal — a large Saturday means packers are chasing hogs.	*SJ_LS710 daily, weekly FI slaughter*
3	**Negotiated market thinness and MPR confidentiality** Only about 2-5% of hogs trade negotiated, yet that price anchors the formula contracts that price the other 95%. A few thousand head can move the reported base $5-7/cwt. Mandatory Price Reporting confidentiality rules suppress regional prints when too few packers report, which removes exactly the comparison points needed to sanity-check an outlier. This is structural fragility, not market information.	*LM_HG218 head counts alongside price*
4	**Managed money positioning** Funds do not transact cash hogs, but they move futures, and futures feed both the Other Market Formula contracts and producer hedging behaviour. Extreme net short positioning raises the probability of a violent short-covering rally and tends to exaggerate moves in both directions.	*CFTC COT weekly, Friday 3:30pm ET*
5	**Export demand, Mexico and China above all** Roughly a quarter to a third of US pork production is exported. Mexico absorbs hams and shoulders in volume; China is the swing buyer and the one most sensitive to tariffs; Japan and Korea pay premiums for specific cuts. One heavy week of Mexican ham buying can lift the ham primal and pull the whole cutout with it.	*FAS weekly export sales, Thursday*
6	**Frozen stocks and cold storage** Monthly, and a demand-side drag when heavy. Large belly and ham inventories mean product the trade could not move fresh, which caps primal values until it clears. Current pork stocks 9% above year-ago is one of the few genuinely bearish fundamentals in this market.	*NASS Cold Storage, ~22nd-25th monthly*
7	**Herd inventory and the forward supply map** Quarterly, and the best forward view available. The 180 lb-and-over class is the next four to six weeks of kill; the under-50 lb class is five to six months out; the breeding herd sets supply ten to twelve months forward. Read it as a calendar, not a snapshot.	*NASS Quarterly Hogs and Pigs*
8	**Average carcass weight** The variable most often missed. Weight gains add tonnage without adding hogs, and heavier carcasses in a falling market usually mean producers are holding back — which builds a backlog that has to clear later.	*LM_HG201 weight distribution*

9	**Feed costs** Slow-moving. Corn and soybean meal do not move the daily base price; they set the producer's floor and shape expansion decisions ten to twelve months out. Cheap corn encourages herd retention, which produces more hogs and lower prices a year later. This is a cycle driver, not a daily one.	*CBOT settlements, AMS cash grain*
10	**Seasonality** The base price typically peaks in June and July and troughs in November and December. Q4 weakness is normal and expected; the question is always magnitude against the five-year pattern, never direction.	*Five-year average overlays*
11	**By-product drop value** Small but real. Packers add hide, offal and rendering value to the carcass when calculating what they can pay. Currently $5.01/cwt.	*Weekly USDA by-product drop value*
12	**Disease, trade and macro shocks** Low probability, high magnitude. PRRS and PEDv seasonal losses, ASF headlines anywhere in the world, tariff announcements, and dollar strength that suppresses export competitiveness. For a Canadian producer selling into the US, a weaker CAD amplifies USD returns on the way back.	*News flow, FX, FAS trade notices*

Data sources, as-of dates and release calendar

Every metric in this report carries its own as-of date. Nothing here is a same-day figure across the board — the underlying series run on different clocks.

Metric	As of	Release frequency	USDA / source report
Negotiated base price	2026-11-06	Daily, ~2:00pm CT	LM_HG218
Producer base, all types	2026-11-06	Daily, prior day	LM_HG201
Pork cutout and primals	2026-11-06	Twice daily	LM_PK602
Sow and boar prices	2026-10-19	Daily, prior day	LM_HG234
SEW and feeder pigs	2026-10-23	Weekly	AMS 2810
Daily slaughter	2026-11-06	Daily	SJ_LS710
Carcass weights	2026-11-04	Daily, prior day	LM_HG215
Corn and soybean meal	2026-11-09	Daily settlement	CBOT
Pork exports	mid-October 2026	Weekly, Thursday	FAS
COT positioning	2026-11-03	Weekly, Friday	CFTC
Cold storage	2026-09-30	Monthly, ~22nd-25th	NASS Cold Storage
Herd inventory	2026-09-01	Quarterly	NASS Hogs & Pigs
Lean hog futures, 3 contracts	2026-11-09	Daily settlement	CME
CME Lean Hog Index	2026-11-04	Daily	CME
USD/CAD	2026-11-05 (approx., carried forward)	Daily	FX reference

Freshness at build time

How each series graded against its own expected refresh cadence when this report was generated.

Series	State	As of	Age	Limit
Negotiated base price	STALE	2026-11-06	3d	1d
* Producer base, all types	STALE	2026-11-06	3d	2d
* Pork carcass cutout	STALE	2026-11-06	3d	1d
* Lean hog futures	FRESH	2026-11-09	0d	0d
CME Lean Hog Index	STALE	2026-11-04	5d	4d
Daily slaughter	FRESH	2026-11-06	3d	3d
Carcass weights	STALE	2026-11-04	5d	3d
Corn & soybean meal	FRESH	2026-11-09	0d	1d
By-product drop value	STALE	2026-10-23	17d	10d
Sow & boar prices	STALE	2026-10-19	21d	6d
SEW & feeder pigs	STALE	2026-10-23	17d	10d
COT positioning	FRESH	2026-11-03	6d	10d

Series	State	As of	Age	Limit
Pork exports	MISSING	mid-October 2026	—	12d
Cold storage	FRESH	2026-09-30	40d	45d
Herd inventory	FRESH	2026-09-01	69d	120d

* marks a core series. 6 of 15 fresh. Core data could not be verified for this session: Producer base, all types, Pork carcass cutout. Report sent with a prominent staleness warning.

Build notes and known gaps

Historical depth — the one thing this sample does not yet carry

You asked for ten years of history on each series. The figures in this report are verified against USDA source documents, but the trend charts are built on the live snapshot window only, because a decade of daily history has to come from the AMS Datamart API (mpr.datamart.ams.usda.gov) and NASS QuickStats rather than from the published PDFs. Those endpoints return full history in JSON and are the right foundation for the scheduled build. No historical values have been estimated or filled in to make a chart look complete — where a series is short, the chart shows only what was verified.

What it takes to switch RSI and MACD on

Ten dated December-contract settlements were verified and are carried in the dataset. That is enough for term structure and momentum but not for the oscillators: RSI(14) needs 30 sessions and MACD(12,26,9) needs 60. Both are fully implemented and validated against reference series — RSI reproduces Wilder's worked example to within 0.07 — so they activate automatically once a daily settlement feed for HEZ26, HEG27 and HEJ27 is connected. Until then the technical block runs at 30% data and PI reports that openly rather than substituting a default. Note that a front-month continuous series cannot be used as a substitute: on 9 October the expiring October contract settled $75.05 while December settled $67.825, so splicing the two would fabricate a 7-point crash that never happened.

Method and conventions

Currency. All primary figures are USD as USDA publishes them. CAD equivalents use 1.3850 and are shown on headline metrics only. The FX rate needs a live source in the scheduled build.

Derived values. The sow weighted average, feed cost per head and per cwt, cutout-to-base spread, revenue per head and COT notional values are calculated in this report, not published by USDA. Each states its assumptions where it appears.

Cold storage 2025 comparisons. Where a prior-year monthly value is shown, it is back-calculated from the published year-over-year percentage rather than read directly, and is labelled as such.

Series that do not reconcile. The CFTC futures-only and futures-plus-options series report different net positions for the same Tuesday. Both appear; neither is blended into a single number.

Source priority. Figures were taken from USDA source documents wherever the document could be read directly. Several commercial aggregators republishing these reports were found to mis-parse the AMS table layouts — one reported the cutout at $183.77 against a true $72.43 — so aggregator figures were not used for any price in this report.

Primary sources

USDA AMS Daily Direct Prior Day Hog Report (LM_HG218)
ams.usda.gov/mnreports/ams_3458.pdf

USDA AMS National Daily Direct Prior Day Slaughtered Swine (LM_HG201)
mymarketnews.ams.usda.gov/viewreport/2872

USDA AMS National Daily Pork Report FOB Plant, PM (LM_PK602)
ams.usda.gov/mnreports/ams_2498.pdf

USDA AMS Daily Direct Prior Day Sow and Boar Report (LM_HG234)
ams.usda.gov/mnreports/ams_3452.pdf

USDA AMS US Direct Delivered Feeder Pig Summary (AMS 2810)
ams.usda.gov/mnreports/lsddhps.pdf

USDA AMS Daily Hog Slaughter Under FIS (SJ_LS710)
ams.usda.gov/mnreports/lsddhps.pdf

USDA NASS Cold Storage
nass.usda.gov/Publications/Todays_Reports/reports/cost1026.pdf

USDA NASS Quarterly Hogs and Pigs
nass.usda.gov/Newsroom/Executive_Briefings/2026/09-24-2026.pdf

USDA FAS Weekly Export Sales (pork muscle cuts)
apps.fas.usda.gov/export-sales/pork.htm

CFTC Commitments of Traders, Lean Hogs (code 054642)
cftc.gov/MarketReports/CommitmentsofTraders

CBOT settlements via AMS Daily Grain Reports
ams.usda.gov/mnreports/ams_3046.pdf

CME Lean Hog futures & Lean Hog Index (HEZ26/HEG27/HEJ27)
cmegroup.com; settlements cross-checked across Investing.com, FXEmpire, Farmbucks, TradingEconomics and daily CME wire reports